National Christmas Tree Lighting 2026 Timeline

Lottery dates, Capitol tree tour stops and the Dec. 3 ceremony

1. **Wed., Oct. 28** ☐
   10 a.m. ET: National Christmas Tree ticket lottery opens
2. **Thu., Oct. 29** ☐
   U.S. Capitol Christmas Tree tour starts in Grangeville, Idaho
3. **Wed., Nov. 4** ☐
   3 p.m. ET: ticket lottery closes
4. **Thu., Nov. 5** ☐
   Capitol tree tour stop in Arco, Idaho
5. **Thu., Nov. 12** ☐
   Lottery winners notified
6. **Fri., Nov. 20** ☐
   Capitol tree arrives at the U.S. Capitol, 10 a.m.
7. **Thu., Dec. 3** ☐
   National Christmas Tree lighting ceremony on the Ellipse

My notes

Sources: National Park Service; National Park Foundation; U.S. Capitol Christmas Tree (USDA Forest Service).